

8.2 The world is developing unevenly

« RECALL AND CONNECT 2 »

Terminology to classify countries according to their level of income is also used in other topics in geography, such as population. See if you can answer the following questions about the classification of countries.

- a** Define 'HIC', 'MIC' and 'LIC'.
- b** Give examples of countries that are HICs, MICs and LICs.

1 The statements below outline reasons for uneven development. Sort the factors into three categories: economic, environmental and social.

- a** Colonialism slowed the development of the colony for the benefit of the colonising country.
- b** Trading primary products brings in less profit than manufactured goods.
- c** Countries with extreme climates may experience droughts and diseases such as malaria.
- d** Frequent natural disasters are expensive and disruptive.
- e** A good infrastructure can attract more foreign investment.
- f** Civil war can prevent a country from spending funds on essential services.

'To what extent' questions require you to judge how true or accurate a statement is. To do this, you must look at both sides of the

argument: points that agree with the statement and those that disagree. Writing about something that contradicts the question is sometimes known as a counterargument. In these questions, it is important to show that you can look at evidence from different perspectives and make a balanced decision, rather than just giving a simple answer. After thinking about the different views, you should give a clear conclusion that explains your overall opinion.

Attempt these 'to what extent' questions by looking at both sides of the argument.

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- ~~2~~ To what extent does climate determine a country's level of economic development? [7]
- ~~3~~ To what extent are natural resources essential for a country's development? [7]
- ~~4~~ Look at the sample answer to the following 'to what extent' question: To what extent does unstable governance limit a country's economic development? [7]

- 1 This can reduce economic development.
- 2 However, unstable governance is not the only factor that affects economic development.
- 3 When governments are unstable, there is often a lack of clear policies, which makes it difficult for businesses to plan and invest confidently.
- 4 In conclusion, while unstable governance is a threat to economic development, its impact can be lessened through external influences such as trade and foreign investment.
- 5 In extreme cases, instability can lead to conflict or war, which disrupts economic activities and damages infrastructure.

- 6 Corruption takes money away from essential services such as healthcare and education.
- 7 Unstable governance can significantly limit a country's economic development by creating uncertainty, discouraging investment and weakening public services.
- 8 In addition to this, unstable governance can lead to corruption or the mismanagement of resources or money.
- 9 Other factors such as international trade, foreign aid or foreign investment from transnational corporations can overcome some of the problems caused by poor governance.

The answer has good elements, but it lacks structure. Put the statements into the correct order to produce an answer with a coherent structure.

REFLECTION

When you look at your answers to Questions 2–3, what do you notice about the structure of your responses? You may notice that the answers follow a similar pattern; one paragraph agrees with the question, another paragraph disagrees and then one paragraph gives an overall conclusion. Having a structure helps you to remember to include a counterargument.